Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills – Level 2

Past Paper 9

Time: 75 minutes | Paper Reference **PENR2/S09**

English

Component 2: Reading
Text Booklet

Do not return this Text Booklet with the Question and Answer Booklet.

Instructions

- You should write your answers in the Question and Answer Booklet.
- You must **not** write any responses to questions in this Text Booklet.

Information

- This Text Booklet contains the three texts required for the Level 2 Component 2: Reading exam.
- This Text Booklet must be securely destroyed by the centre immediately after the exam has been completed.

Advice

- Read each text before you answer the questions.

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PRACTICE PAPER

Turn over ▶

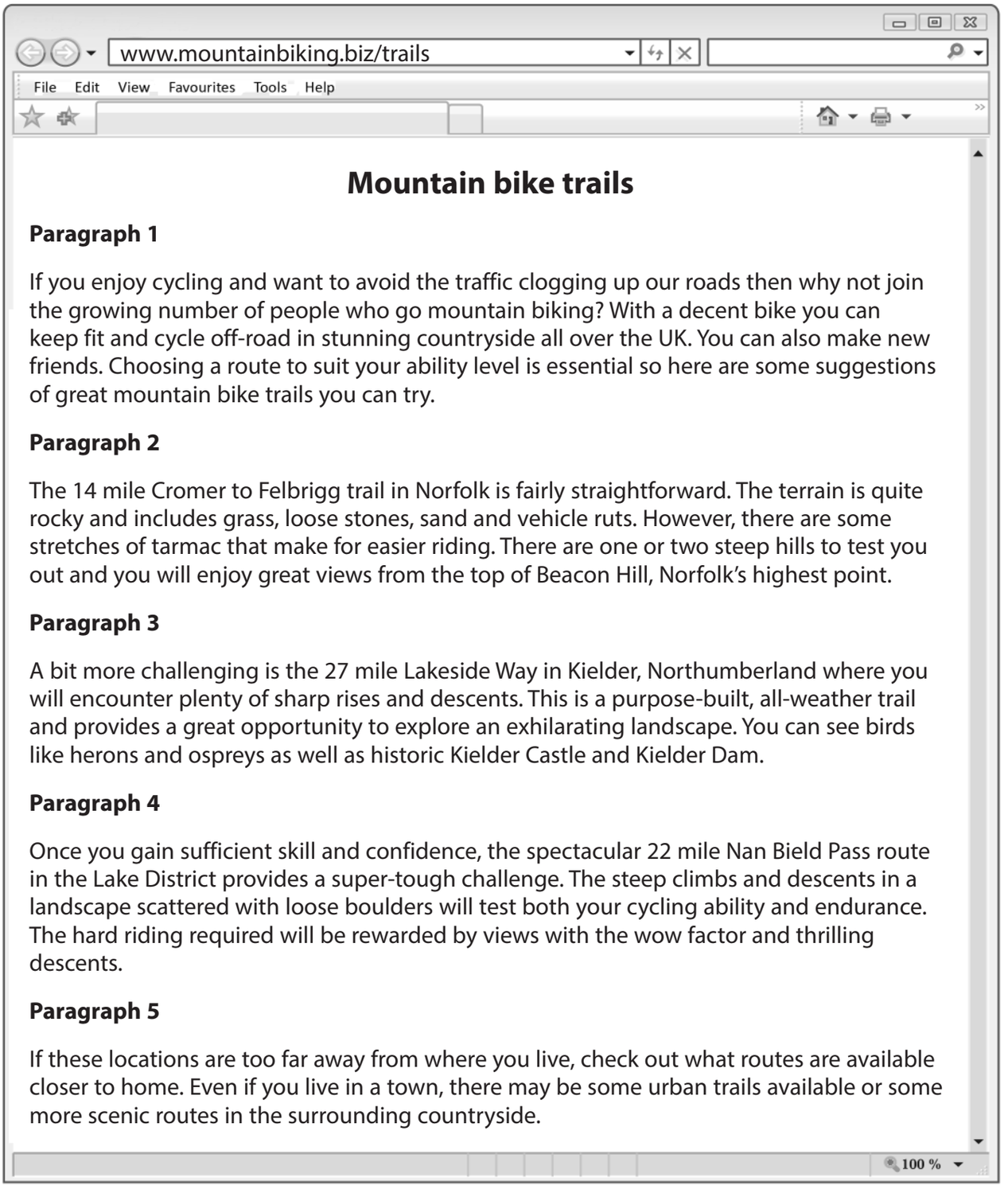
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Text A

Webpage



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Text B

Article

Beginners' guide to mountain biking

by Chris Alston

I enjoy everything about mountain biking, particularly the adrenaline rush it produces as well as the time I spend in the great outdoors. Mountain biking is not just about rocks, bumps and dips. There are local bridleways and open moorlands that can be enjoyed and the sport is accessible to anyone who can ride a bike and wants some real adventure in their life.

Some forestry trails can be ridden on a fairly standard, cheap and cheerful bike with front suspension, but if you wish to tackle a more challenging landscape, you may want to buy a full suspension mountain bike, which will provide a more comfortable ride. Any bike shop can give you advice – just visit the one in your local area.

It doesn't matter how old you are as all ages can enjoy mountain biking and the sport is booming. You'll be pleasantly surprised by how many local opportunities for mountain biking exist. You can find beginners' courses across the country and the Cycling UK website is a good place to look for a heads-up about events in your area. You could even become a fully-fledged leader, guiding groups on off-road routes and trails.

To anyone who is nervous about trying mountain biking, I say give it a go as it is not as scary as you might think. If you already have bike skills, you will be fine. You can make it as easy or as difficult as you like and you can always hire the equipment you will need before committing to buying, just in case mountain biking is not for you. Rising numbers of people love it – the thrill of riding through forests and areas off the beaten track is amazing and there are numerous benefits for mental health and physical wellbeing. Plus, there are many social benefits from riding with a group, meeting new people and making new friends.

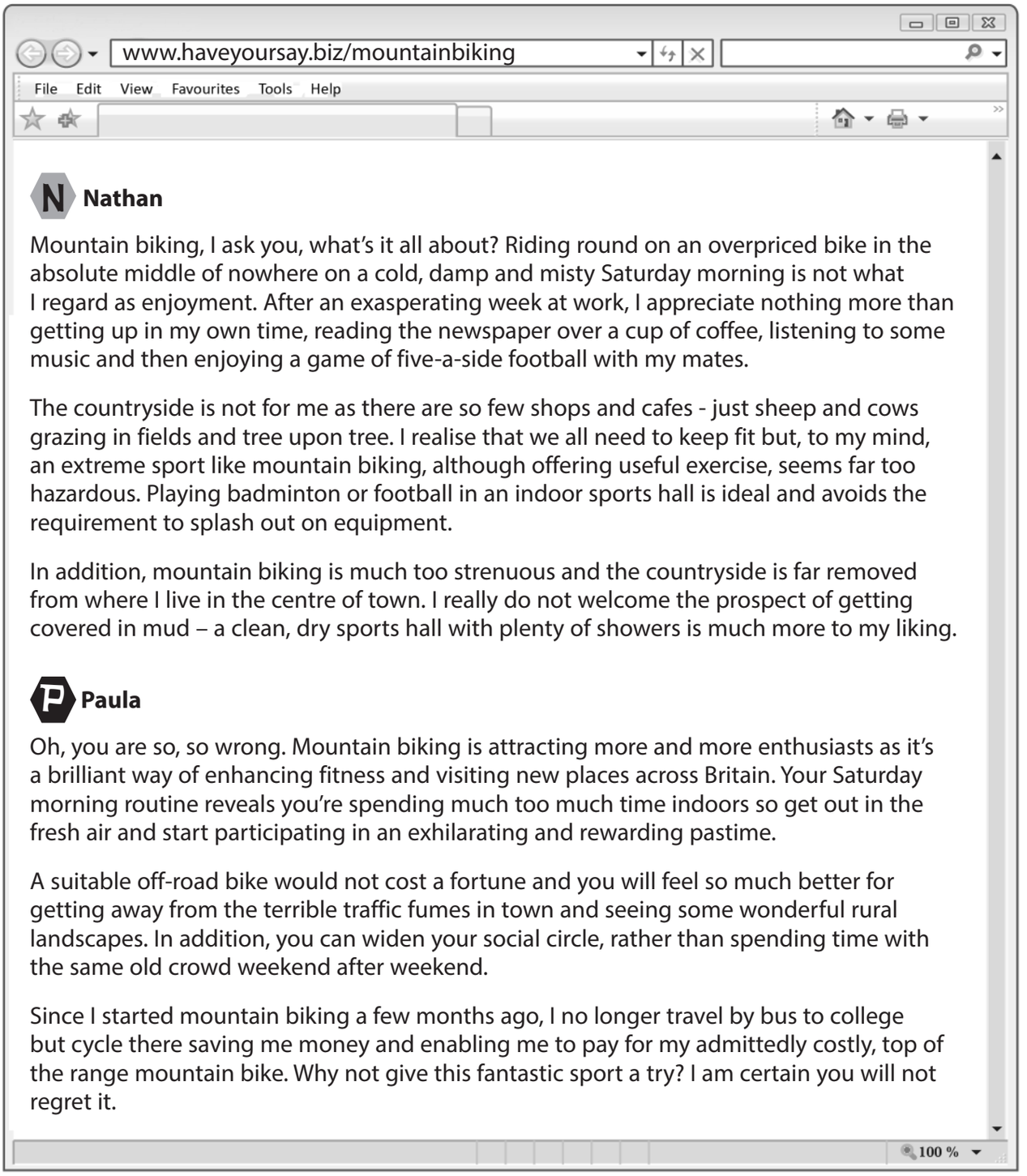
Chris Alston is an experienced mountain bike leader who works as a Development Officer for Cycling UK.

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Adapted from: 'Beginners' guide to mountain biking' by Angellica Bell, Waitrose Magazine

Text C

Discussion forum



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